

The essential 101 glossary

There are a few terms that we come across in our daily lives but might not know what they actually stand for or mean. Here are a few commonly used terms and their explanations

KDE: Set up on the free open source software ideology, it's a set of applications that run on various platforms. KDE is best known for its Plasma desktop environment. A number of Linux distributions such as openSUSE and Kubuntu have this desktop environment as their default. The term KDE is sort of a scrambled version of a common desktop environment that was available for UNIX systems. Much like KDE is GNOME



3G: Despite all the hoopla around the 3G services thanks to mobile operators' advertising, you still might not understand what the 3G mania is all about. The third generation of mobile telecommunications is a standard set by IMT (International Mobile Telecommunications). The service provided under the 3G umbrella includes voice telephone, mobile internet, video calls and mobile TV. Minimum data rate which needs to be maintained is 2 Mbit/s.



It's a common practise in enterprise IT where the computer processing power is perceived as a utility for which clients can pay for as and when it's needed.

PING: You might have used the term "ping" while sending a message to somebody, however, traditionally ping is a utility which is used to test the host's reachability on an IP (internet protocol). Ping is used to measure the round trip time for messages which are sent from the host to the destination computer. This works by sending a packet to a specified address and waiting for a reply.

Cloud computing: This has been quite the buzzword in the industry for some time now, and everyone seems to be yapping about the strength and potential of it. Companies use cloud computing to provide data computation, access and storage services. The idea of everything's on the cloud and accessible everywhere has manifested in today's world. Cloud computing is more of a service than a product where shared resources and information is given to computers

Bandwidth: Expressed in bits/ second, this is a measure of consumed or available data communication resources. It's essentially the



difference between two frequencies and the amount of information that can flow through a channel. There can be data, network or digital bandwidth. Textual information states bandwidth as an analog signal bandwidth measured in hertz.

Middleware: Can be understood as a set of software services which allows the interaction of multiple processes on different machines to come together. In other words, middleware sits in between different application software that may be working on various operating systems.



Hot Spot: The next time you head out to a coffee shop which has a hot spot don't be alarmed, for it simply provides an internet access over wireless LAN through a router connected to an internet service provider. You can use a hot spot using your Wi-Fi enabled laptop or phone. Hot spots can be both, free or commercially available.



Router: Responsible for forwarding data packets between computer networks. A router joins two networks like LAN or an ISP network and directs traffic functions on the internet. Routers simply pass data between the computer and the modem or internet cable. 

Virtualisation: A method of dividing the resources of a computer so that it can be used in various execution environments. Virtualisation is divided into hardware, software, partial or complete machine simulation.

